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RDF & SPARQL: Exercises

Practical Recap + Examples



dat•AI data * AI
AI * data

Overview

- Recap on RDF
- Recap on SPARQL



Indicates content that is more interesting from a pragmatic point of view and/or novel w.r.t. theory slides

This presentation

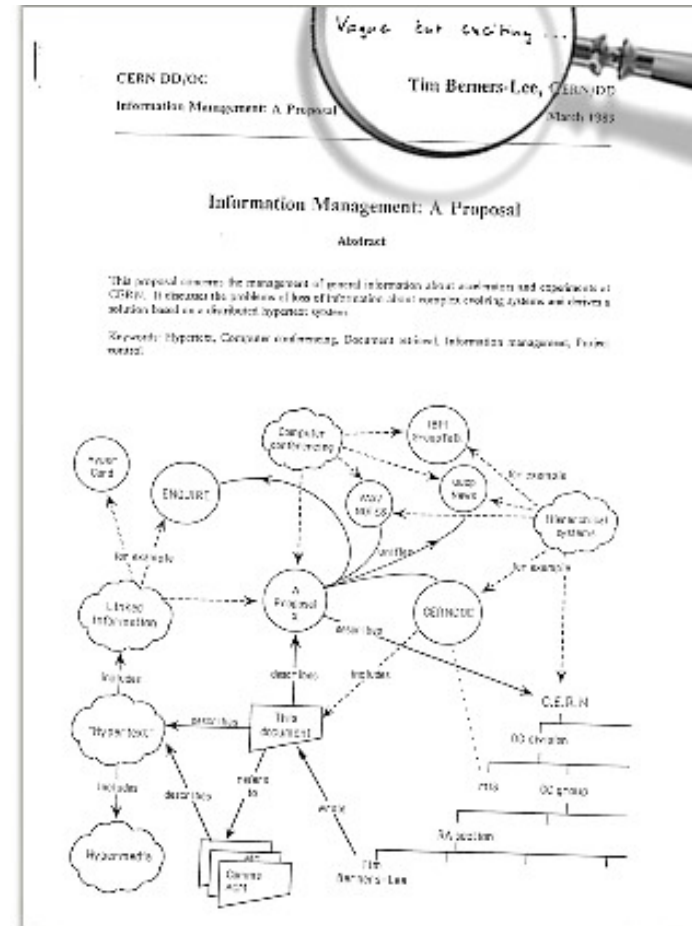
- Exercises in RDF + SPARQL
 - For RDF exercise this year also consider
 - DS2526 - ESE1.0 - Exercises about RDF modeling
- Exercises in Advanced SPARQL

1. RDF Recap

Recap and more about syntax

Tim's proposal¹:

A graph representation of the knowledge



RDF Model

George Clooney birthplace is Lexington Us and he was born on 6 May 1961

(Subject, predicate, object)

(George Clooney, birthplace, Lexington US)

(George Clooney, birthdate, 6 May 1961)

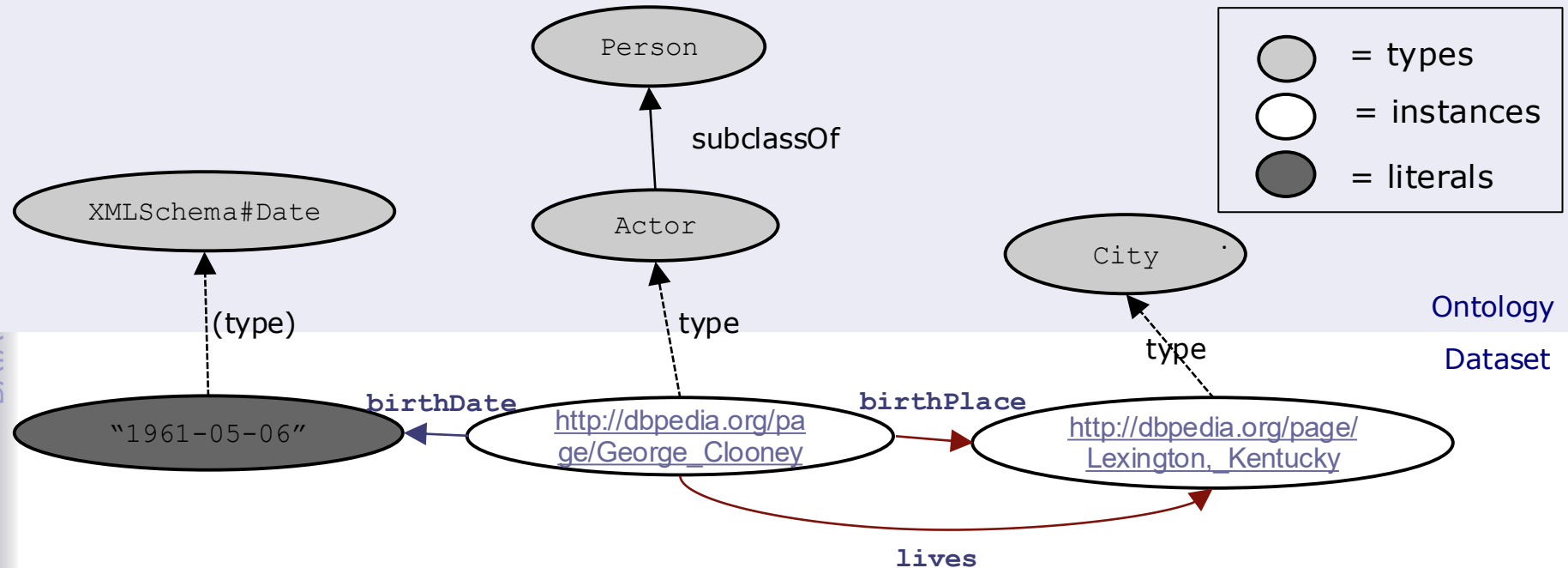
The subject is a resource (not a literal)

The predicate is identified by a URI

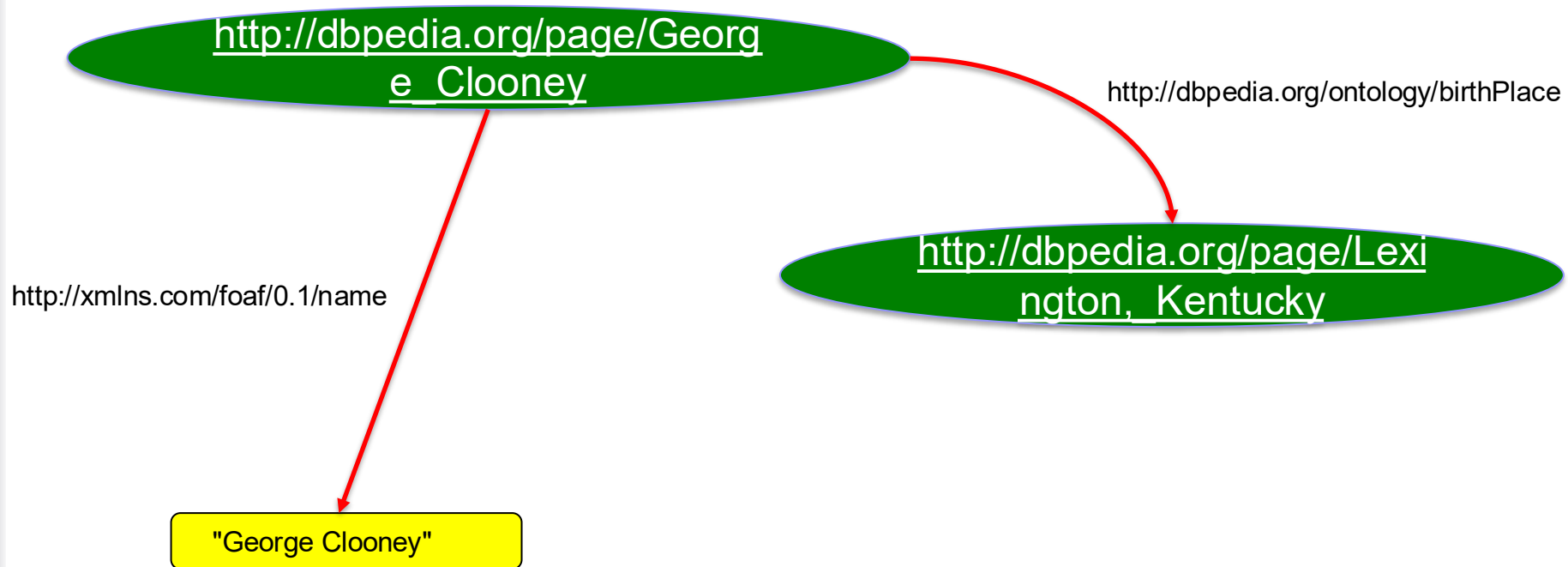
The object is either a resource or a literal

RDF oriented labeled multigraph model

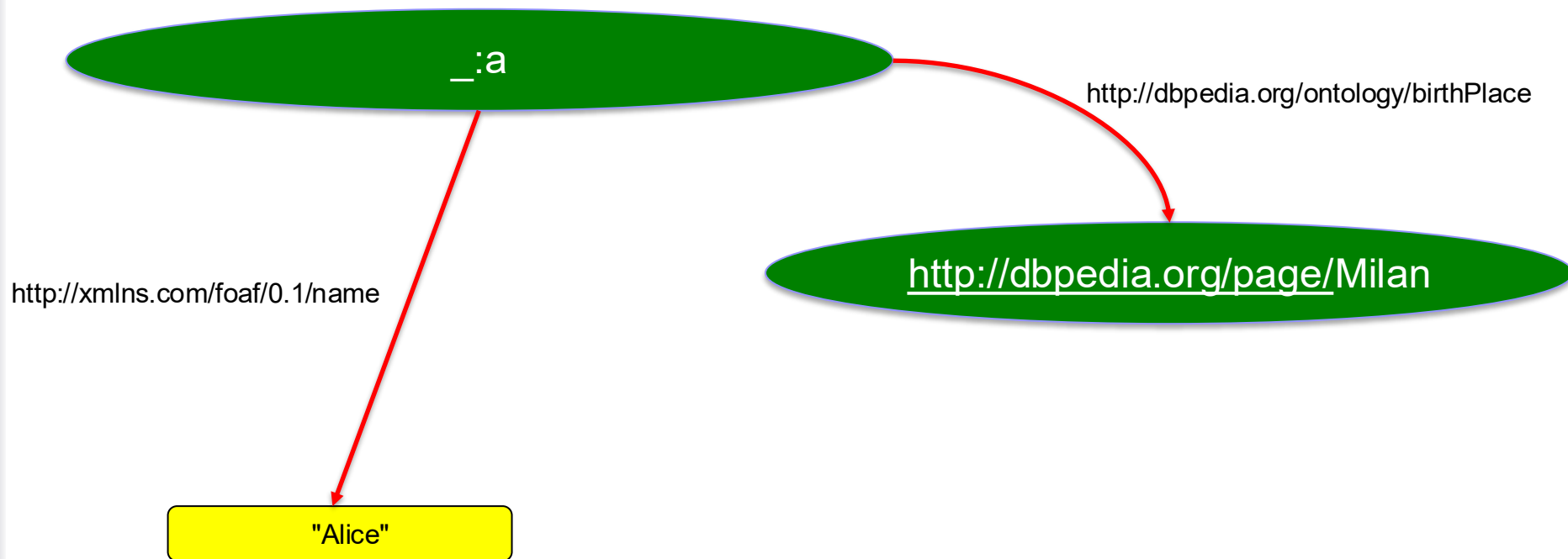
George Clooney birthplace is Lexington Us and he was born on 6 May 1961



RDF Conventions

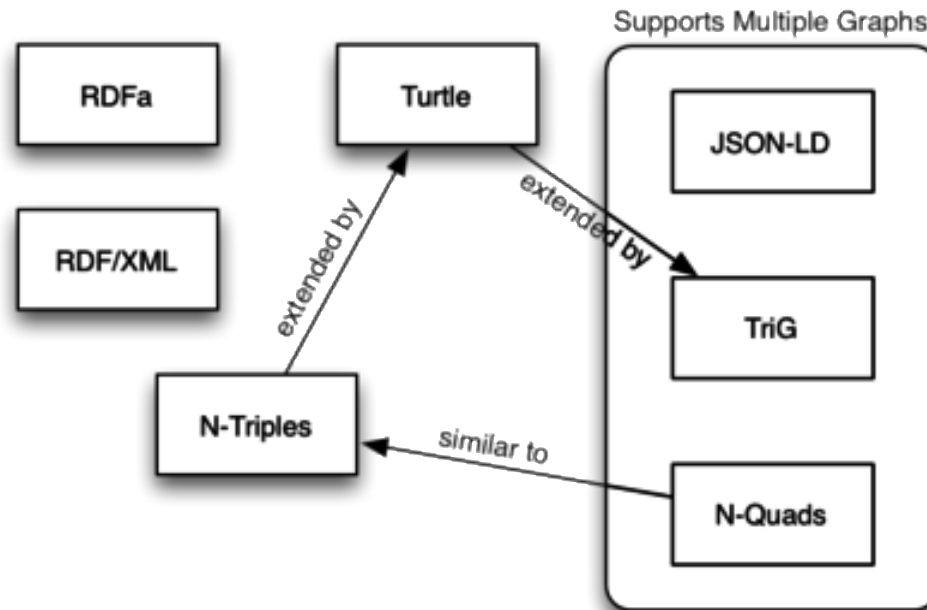


RDF Conventions



Serialization Syntaxes

- RDF has a historical XML syntax and several other syntaxes: Turtle, TriG, JSON-LD, N-Triples, N-Quads



RDF/XML capturing graphs into trees

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8" ?>
```

```
<rdf:RDF
```

```
  xmlns:rdf="http://www.w3.org/1999/02/22-rdf-syntax-ns#"
  xmlns:dbo="http://dbpedia.org/ontology/"
  xmlns:foaf="http://xmlns.com/foaf/0.1/" >
```

```
  <rdf:Description rdf:about="http://dbpedia.org/resource/George_Clooney">
```

```
    <dbo:birthDate rdf:datatype="http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema#date">1961-05-06</dbo:birthDate>
```

```
    <dbo:birthPlace rdf:resource="http://dbpedia.org/resource/Lexington,_Kentucky">
```

```
    <foaf:givenName xml:lang="en">George</foaf:givenName>
```

```
  </rdf:Description>
```

```
</rdf:RDF>
```

N-Triples: a minimalist syntax

```
<http://dbpedia.org/resource/George_Clooney>  
  <http://dbpedia.org/ontology/birthDate>  
    "1961-5-6"^^<http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema#date> .
```

```
<http://dbpedia.org/resource/George_Clooney>  
  <http://dbpedia.org/ontology/birthPlace>  
    <http://dbpedia.org/resource/Lexington,_Kentucky> .
```

```
<http://dbpedia.org/resource/George_Clooney>  
  <http://xmlns.com/foaf/0.1/givenName>  
    "George"@en .
```

```
<http://dbpedia.org/resource/George_Clooney>  
  <http://www.w3.org/1999/02/22-rdf-syntax-ns#type>  
    <http://dbpedia.org/ontology/Person> .
```

Turtle: the most popular syntax

@prefix dbo: <http://dbpedia.org/ontology/> .

@prefix dbr: <http://dbpedia.org/resource/> .



<http://dbpedia.org/resource/George_Clooney>

dbo:birthPlace <http://dbpedia.org/resource/Lexington,_Kentucky> ;

dbo:birthDate "1961-05-06"^^xsd:date .

[dbo:name "Blerina" ;
 dbo:partOf dbr:InsideGroup]

[...] → refers to triples that
have a blank node as subject

<http://dbpedia.org/resource/George_Clooney>

dbo:spuse

[dbo:name "Blerina" ;
 dbo:partOf dbr:InsideGroup] .

2. SPARQL

Recap + Additional Information

Additional / more useful info in slides with marks (i)

Query with SPARQL

SELECT **what you want**
FROM **from where you want**
WHERE **{as you want}**

Turtle syntax with question marks for **variables**:
?x rdf:type ex:Person

Query with SPARQL

- Triples with common subject:

```
SELECT ?name ?fname
```

```
WHERE {?x a ex:Person;  
        ex:name ?name ;  
        ex:firstname ?fname ;  
        ex:author ?y . }
```

```
SELECT ?name ?fname
```

```
WHERE{?x rdf:type ex:Person.  
      ?x ex:name ?name .  
      ?x ex:firstname ?fname .  
      ?x ex:author ?y . }
```

- Several values:

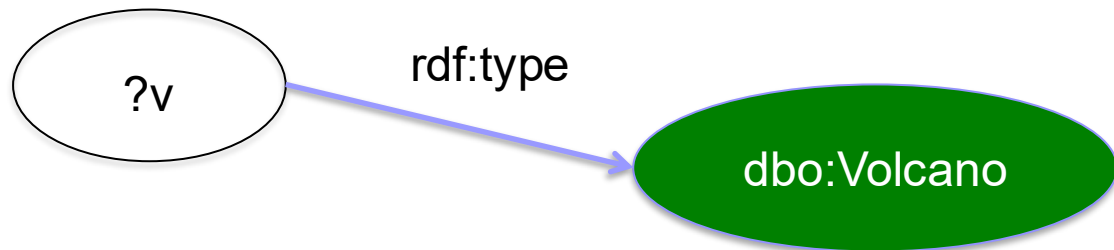
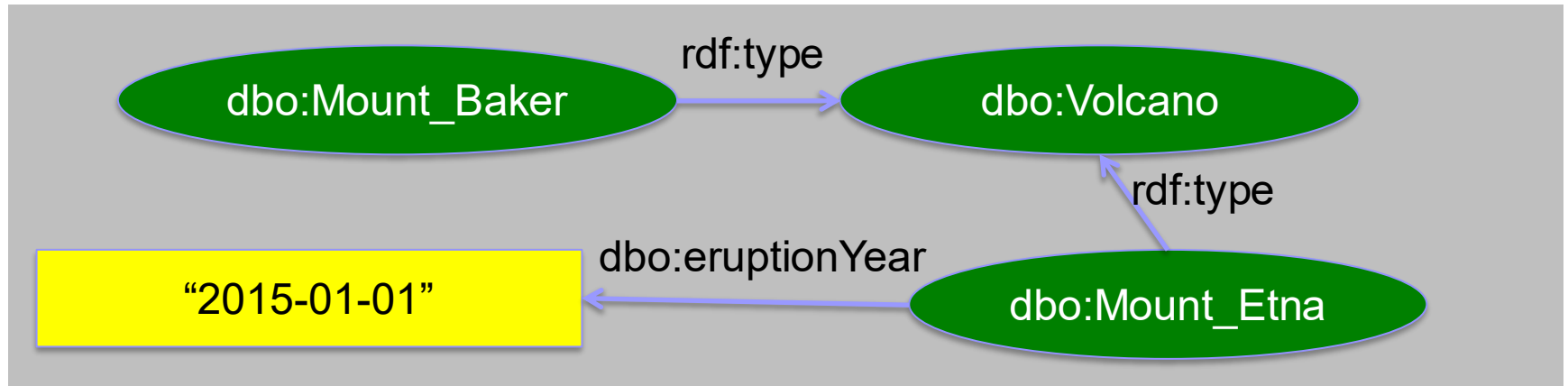
```
?x ex:firstname "Blerina", "Alice" .
```

- Blank nodes as anonymous variables:

```
[ ex:firstname "Blerina" ]
```

```
[] ex:firstname "Blerina" .
```

Main Idea of SPARQL Queries



Results:

?v
dbo:Mount_Baker
dbo:Mount_Etna

Components of the SPARQL query

PREFIX rdf: <<http://www.w3.org/1999/02/22-rdf-syntax-ns#>>

PREFIX dbo: <<http://dbpedia.org/ontology/>>

SELECT ?v

FROM <<http://dbpedia.org>>

WHERE {

 ?v rdf:type dbo:Volcano .

}

Conventions

Red text means:

“This is a core part of the SPARQL syntax or language.”

Green text means:

“This is an example of query-specific text or values that might go into a SPARQL query.”

SPARQL lego

Write full URIs:

`<http://this.is.a/full/URI/written#out>`

Abbreviate URIs with prefixes:

PREFIX `ex: <http://this.is.a/URI/prefix#>`

`ex:university -> <http://this.is.a/URI/prefix#university>`

Shortcuts:

`a -> rdf:type`

Plain literals:

`"a plain literal"`

Plain literal with language tag:

`"buongiorno"@it`

Typed literal:

`"23"^^xsd:integer`

Shortcuts:

`true -> "true"^^xsd:boolean`

`8 -> "8"^^xsd:integer`

`5.6 -> "5.6"^^xsd:decimal`

Variables:

`?var1, ?anotherVar, ?and_one_more`

Comments:

`# Comments start with a '#' and
continue to the end of the line`

Match an exact RDF triple:

`ex:myFiscalCode ex:partNumber "XYZ" .`

Match one variable:

`?person foaf:name "Albert Einstein" .`

Match multiple variables:

`ex:Unimib ?property ?value .`

Anatomy of a SPARQL query

Declare prefix
shortcuts
(*optional*)

→ {
PREFIX ex: <...>
PREFIX dc: <...>
...

Define the dataset
(*optional*)

→ {
SELECT ...
FROM <...>
FROM NAMED <...>
WHERE {
...
}

← Query result clause

Query modifiers
(*optional*)

→ {
GROUP BY ...
HAVING ...
ORDER BY ...
LIMIT ...
OFFSET ...
VALUES ...

← Query pattern

4 Types of SPARQL Queries

SELECT queries

Project out specific variables and expressions:

```
SELECT ?c ?cap (1000 * ?people AS ?pop)
```

Project out all variables:

```
SELECT *
```

Project out distinct combinations only:

```
SELECT DISTINCT ?country
```

Results in a table of values (in XML or JSON)

?c	?cap	?pop
ex:France	ex:Paris	63,500,000
ex:CANADA	ex:Ottawa	32,900,000
ex:Italy	ex:Rome	58,900,000

CONSTRUCT queries

Construct RDF triples / graphs

```
CONSTRUCT {  
    ?country a ex:HolidayDestination ;  
    ex:arrive_at ?capital ;  
    ex:population ?population .  
}
```

Results in RDF triples (in any RDF serialization):

```
ex:France a ex:HolidayDestination;  
    ex:arrive_at ex:Paris ;  
    ex:population 63500000 .  
ex:Canada a ex:a ex:HolidayDestination;  
    ex:arrive_at ex:Ottawa ;  
    ex:population 32900000 .
```

Describe queries

Describe the resources matched by the given variables:

```
DESCRIBE ?country
```

Results are RDF triples (in any RDF serialization):

```
ex:France a geo:Country ;  
ex:continent geo:Europe ;  
ex:flag http://\_/flag-france.png ;
```

ASK queries

Ask whether or not there are any matches:

```
ASK
```

Results is either "true" or "false" (in XML or JSON):

```
True, false
```

USEFUL PATTERNS
EXMPLAINED with

SELECT

Optional Pattern



- When part of graph pattern is not mandatory

PREFIX foaf: <http://xmlns.com/foaf/0.1/>

SELECT ?person ?name

WHERE {

 ?person foaf:homepage <http://blerinaspahiu.com> .

OPTIONAL

 { ?person foaf:name ?name . }

}

Alternative Patterns



- Union of results of graph patterns

```
PREFIX foaf: <http://xmlns.com/foaf/0.1/>
```

```
SELECT ?person ?name
```

```
WHERE {
```

```
    ?person foaf:name ?name .
```

```
    {
```

```
        ?person foaf:homepage <http://website.info>.
```

```
    }
```

```
    UNION
```

```
    {
```

```
        ?person foaf:homepage <http://site.info>.
```

```
    }
```

```
}
```


Difference (~ can handle negation)

- Remove results that match a pattern

```
PREFIX ex: <http://www.example.org#>
SELECT ?x
WHERE {
    ?x a ex:Person
    MINUS { ?x a ex:Man }
}
```

Predefined Variable Values



- Results where part of the bindings are predefined

PREFIX foaf: <http://xmlns.com/foaf/0.1/>

SELECT ?person ?name

WHERE {

 ?person foaf:name ?name .

}

VALUES ?name { "Blerina" "Loris" "Alice" }

Variable Binding

- Results where part of the bindings are computed

PREFIX foaf: <http://xmlns.com/foaf/0.1/>

SELECT ?person ?name

WHERE {

 ?person ex:fname ?fname ;

 ex:lname ?lname .

BIND (concat(?fname, ?lname) AS ?name)

}

Distinct



- Keep one occurrence of similar results with same values for same variables

```
PREFIX foaf: <http://xmlns.com/foaf/0.1/>
```

```
SELECT DISTINCT ?name
```

```
WHERE {
```

```
    ?person foaf:name ?name .
```

```
}
```

Filter Results by Values



```
PREFIX ex: <http://www.example.org#>
SELECT ?person ?name
WHERE {
    ?person rdf:type ex:Person ;
             ex:name ?name ;
             ex:age ?age .
    FILTER (xsd:integer(?age) >= 18)
}
```

Test Values



- Test and compare constants, variables and expressions
- Comparators: , =, <=, >=, !=
- Regular expressions: regex(?x, "A.*")
- Test variable values: isURI(?x), isBlank(?x), isLiteral(?x), bound(?x)

Strings and Literals



- string inclusion
CONTAINS(lit1,lit2),STRSTARTS(lit1,lit2),STREND(lit1,lit2)
- create literal with datatype
STRDT(value, type)
- create literal with language
STRLANG(value, lang)
- concatenate strings
CONCAT(lit1,...,litn)
- extract substring
SUBSTR(lit, start [,length])

Boolean Connectors



- And: &&
- Or: ||
- Not: !
- ()

Branching Expression

- Usual test: if then else

```
PREFIX foaf: <http://xmlns.com/foaf/0.1/>
```

```
SELECT *
```

```
WHERE { ?x foaf:name ?name ;  
        foaf:age ?age .
```

```
FILTER ( if (langMatches(lang(?name), "IT"), ?age >=  
18, ?age >= 21) )  
}
```

Presence / Absence of a Pattern

- exists checks whether a pattern occurs in the graph
- not exists checks whether a pattern does not occur in the graph

```
SELECT ?name
WHERE {
    ?x foaf:name ?name .
    FILTER NOT EXISTS { ?x dbo:age -1 }
}
```

Specify Default Graph

PREFIX ex: <http://www.example.org#>

SELECT ?student

FROM <http://www.example.org/dataset1.rdf>

FROM <http://www.example.org/dataset2.rdf>

WHERE { ?student ex:registeredAt ?x . }

Query Remote SPARQL Endpoint

```
SELECT ?x
WHERE {
  SERVICE <http://dbpedia.org/sparql> {
    ?x rdfs:label "Alice"@it .
  }
}
```

Order and Limit Results



- E.g.: sort results by name from n° 21 to n° 40

PREFIX foaf: <http://xmlns.com/foaf/0.1/>

SELECT ?name

WHERE {

 ?x foaf:name ?name .

}

ORDER BY ?name

LIMIT 20

OFFSET 20

Aggregate Queries

- Group results by variable(s) values: group by
- Aggregate values: count, sum, min, max, avg, group_concat, sample
- Filter aggregated values: having

PREFIX ex: <http://www.example.org#>

SELECT ?student

WHERE { ?student ex:score ?score . }

GROUP BY ?student

HAVING(AVG(?score) >= 10)

CONSTRUCTS

CONSTRUCT query

- Result of query is a fresh new RDF graph

```
PREFIX ex: <http://www.example.org#>
```

```
PREFIX dbo: <http://dbpedia.org/resource/>
```

```
CONSTRUCT { ?student a dbo:Person . }
```

```
WHERE { ?student a ex:Student . }
```


DESCRIBE

DESCRIBE query

- Discover unknown data

DESCRIBE <http://dbpedia.org/resource/Milan>

PREFIX foaf: <http://xmlns.com/foaf/0.1/>

DESCRIBE ?x WHERE { ?x foaf:name "Alice" }

ASK

ASK query

PREFIX foaf: <http://xmlns.com/foaf/0.1/>

ASK { ?person foaf:age 130 . }

DATA MANIPULATION

SPARQL Updates

- Load
- Delete
- Insert
- Copy
- Move
- Add

Please refer to <https://www.w3.org/TR/rdf-sparql-query/> for SPARQL specification

FOR DETAILS